Diego Palominos

Cloud Architect & Software Engineer · 13+ years · builds the product, runs the platform

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SUMMARY

Founded Eleva in 2017 for schools that needed staff evaluations they could trust; it won Startup Chile Ignite (generation 4, 2022) and still runs in production. Since 2024 I lead Liquor Cart, which turned on-premise registers and an online store into one system the business runs without a developer. Deployments are pipelines that roll back on their own: Eleva shipped 19 times last month, none failed. I build the product and keep it predictable — usually two jobs, on my systems one.

SELECTED ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- **Built from zero, still in production:** Eleva, a multitenant SaaS for schools, since 2017. One CDK stack class and one config record describe dev, qa and prod, so a new environment is a pull request.
- **Made delivery predictable:** 19 production deploys in 30 days, none failed, a commit live in about nine minutes, and ECS rolls a bad one back itself — every push to main, through three CodePipelines.
- **Turned audits into a glance:** Eleva's ops panel reads the architecture from deployed CloudFormation, checks drift per resource, and every image carries its commit hash.
- **Designed for safe recovery:** one RabbitMQ virtual host per Liquor Cart store; a saga reconciles money with orders — voids, refunds, cancels or completes under idempotent keys; unclear cases go to a person.
- **Time to update, known by design:** an order reaches the broker as it commits and the register once paid, a product is live on the next request once written, a release is budgeted at ten minutes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Architect & Full-Stack Engineer, Electronic Payments

Feb 2024 – Present | Contract | Remote

- Led the replacement of a legacy commerce platform with Liquor Cart: registers stay on-premise, the Magento storefront runs in AWS, and the two operate as one system.
- Designed the middleware on MassTransit over RabbitMQ (Amazon MQ) and wrote nine of every ten lines of its C#. Each store gets its own virtual host, created at onboarding and deleted at retirement.
- Gave the payment saga a clock the broker cannot keep: deadlines live in Postgres, swept every minute. First check two minutes after settlement, then up to four more five minutes apart, then a person.
- Made the consumers safe to repeat: transactional outbox and inbox, deterministic message ids, five retries backing off from a second to five minutes, then an error queue an operator can replay.
- Put an anti-corruption layer in front of the event-sourced order book: 8 event kinds, wire values frozen so the domain can evolve. An unknown kind is acknowledged and dropped, not retried.
- An order is published the moment it commits. The middleware pulls it, acknowledges it back and posts it to the register once paid. A ten-minute cron retries failures and marks rows stalled after thirty.
- Replaced manual deployments with CI/CD to AWS: Magento on ECS, Aurora and FSx, defined in CDK and deployed to dev, qa and prod accounts from one trunk, with prod behind a manual approval.
- Set the conventions a six-person team ships through and mentored its juniors — 178 pull requests merged, 1,600+ unit tests on every push.

Founder & Platform Architect, Eleva (eleva.school)

2017 – Present | Founder | Viña del Mar, Chile · Remote

- Founded Eleva in 2017 and still run it in production: a multitenant SaaS for schools' 360-degree performance evaluations and improvement plans. Startup Chile Ignite winner, generation 4 (2022).
- Architected the platform as code with CDK and Projen: a .NET API on ECS Fargate behind API Gateway (no ALB, no NAT to pay for), a 104-component Angular SPA on S3/CloudFront, PostgreSQL 17 on RDS.
- Designed the platform to tolerate being off: at 21:00 every weekday ECS scales to zero and RDS stops, and it comes back on request. Cold starts are routine, not incidents.
- Built the ops control panel: it renders the architecture from deployed CloudFormation, checks drift per resource, tails logs and approves pipeline gates. New stacks appear in it by convention.
- Designed the event-driven domain so tenants stay isolated and results stay auditable: versioned rubrics and scales, a four-stage evaluation lifecycle, and weighted 360° scores that compensate for missing evaluators.

Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer, GRUBBRR
Apr 2022 – Aug 2023 | Contract | Boca Raton, Florida, USA · Remote

- Worked across the C# .NET Core backend of a self-service kiosk commerce platform (GraphQL, gRPC, Cosmos DB data models), from requirements gathering through code review to debugging in production.
- Built the front-end of the Clover SMB product in Angular 13.

Software Engineer, Freelance
Jan 2014 – Jul 2020 | Full-time | Viña del Mar, Chile · Remote

- Ran a freelance practice for six and a half years: front-ends in Angular and React, APIs in Node.js, .NET Core and Java, and the AWS architectures clients launched their MVPs on.

PHP Full-Stack Developer, Centro Científico Tecnológico de Valparaíso (CCTVal)
Feb 2013 – Jul 2014 | Part-time | Valparaíso, Chile · On-site

- Developed the SQL databases (PHP, ORM) behind a scientific computing centre's research tooling.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Systems Engineering
Ingeniería de Ejecución en Sistemas Computacionales — Universidad Técnica Federico Santa María (UTFSM), Valparaíso, Chile

SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (ECS Fargate, RDS, Aurora, FSx, S3, CloudFront, API Gateway, ElastiCache, OpenSearch, Amazon MQ, CloudFormation), AWS CDK, cdk-nag, Docker, Infrastructure as Code

Architecture: Event-driven architecture, event sourcing, CQRS, sagas, domain-driven design, transactional outbox, modular monoliths and microservices, multitenancy, hybrid cloud, distributed systems

Operations & Testing: Environment parity, drift detection, approval gates, observability (OpenTelemetry), scheduled power-down, Playwright end-to-end tests, xunit and Jest, Veracode scans

Backend: C#, .NET (Core to 9), Marten, MassTransit, EF Core, Polly, YARP, Node.js, TypeScript, NestJS, Java (JEE, Spring Boot), PHP, GraphQL, gRPC, REST

Frontend: Angular (2–19), RxJS, React, TypeScript, Tailwind (Hyvä), GSAP

Data & Messaging: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Aurora, Cosmos DB, Redis, OpenSearch, RabbitMQ, SymmetricDS

Commerce: Magento 2.4, Hyvä, custom checkout, POS integration (XT), delivery (DoorDash), payments (TokenEx, RapidConnect, KMS envelope encryption), regulated-category compliance (OHLQ)

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · English (professional working proficiency)